



BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter **The Daily Ceilidh**
in association with

NEW BERNERA BRIDGE OPENS 15 DECEMBER



The formal opening ceremony has been announced for the new Bernera Bridge. This will take place on Wednesday 15th December, with final touches being made right up to the deadline, and with approach roads having been brought up level with the link.

The Comhairle nan Eilean Siar announced the opening and invites all residents to attend the official ceremony at 12pm on Wednesday 15th December at the bridge. There will be a short ceremony on the bridge and afterwards speeches will take place, as well as refreshments served including soup and sandwiches, in the hall.

The invitation extended by CnES is to attend both the opening ceremony and the event at the Hall. Masks are required in the hall, and may be taken off when seated at tables, and registering at the hall entrance is mandatory.

Large vehicles have already been allowed to cross, albeit by appointment and so slowly life has been returning to normal and many of those waiting over a year for heavy deliveries have been taking advantage of the new bridge. Angus Gillies and the team have been working hard to get it finished and everyone must be looking forward to having it open for all traffic soon. We will be featuring an in depth interview with Angus in the next issue of the BN.

The Bernera Community Association will also be holding its own full commemoration of the bridge in 2022 when the weather is better, covid restrictions have eased and they can accommodate the whole community in the spirit of togetherness and celebration.

We're about to open a second bridge to Bernera and so celebrating twice seems appropriate!

As we bring 2021 to a close here at the Bernera News, we give thanks for time with family and friends, and for the support we have received from the community. Year endings are a time for exchanging cards and gifts and festive get-togethers, with friends and family, where we can pause and remember fondly those who are far away or no longer with us, and reminisce about what we have done throughout the year. This year has brought much uncertainty and change to us all yet again, but 2022 looks to be more hopeful.

Thanks to our lovely contributors for all the brilliant content they have provided during the year. Special thanks to Careen and Colin, who have both contributed content so unstintingly again, and to our fabulous local distributors, Andrea, Chrisetta, Paul, Ben, Claire, Helen, Fiona, Natalie and Rebecca, for making it possible to get the BN out to the community so efficiently. You have served the community brilliantly again this year and we are grateful for your efforts. Thanks also to you all for supporting our work this year. The feedback has been most appreciated and we are glad you are still enjoying it as much as we enjoy putting it together. We have had a few enquiries about how people can support our voluntary work, here at the Bernera News as well as a few unsolicited donations. It is funded mostly by our own funds and any sponsorships or donations are always welcome.

We're signing off, wishing you all a Merry Christmas and a peaceful new year.

Nollaig Chridheil

Julia, Nat, Sam and Virginia

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Text/Whatsapp: 07958 549784

Email: hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk

Or visit us online at:

www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk



LANGABHAT MEDICAL PRACTICE

Christmas and New Year Opening Hours 2021/2022

As usual, we are closed on the Public Holidays over Christmas and New Year, so please make sure you order any medications in good time. We will not issue more than the usual one month's medication over the festive period.

Here are our opening hours for the three weeks of Christmas and New Year:

Week commencing 20 December

Monday 20 December	All sites - usual hours
Tuesday 21 December	All sites - usual hours
Wednesday 22 December	All sites - usual hours
Thursday 23 December	All sites - usual hours
Friday 24 December	All sites close at 4pm

Week commencing 27 December

Monday 27 December Public Holiday	All sites closed
Tuesday 28 December Public Holiday	All sites closed
Wednesday 29 December	All sites - usual hours
Thursday 30 December	All sites - usual hours
Friday 31 December	All sites close at 4pm

Week commencing 3 January, 2022

Monday 3 January Public Holiday	All sites closed
Tuesday 4 January Public Holiday	All sites closed
Wednesday 5 January	All sites - usual hours
Thursday 6 January	All sites - usual hours
Friday 7 January	All sites - usual hours

If you need help or advice during these Public Holidays, please call 111, or 999 if it is an emergency, as you would do outwith our usual surgery hours or over a weekend.



GREAT BERNERA COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT TRUST

Community Development Officer - Salary: £24000 - Fixed Term: 31st March 2023

Great Bernera Community Development Trust is looking for an outgoing and self-motivated individual to support our work as we complete the installation of pontoons at Kirkibost and seek to attract funding for other projects including Restaurant facilities, affordable housing and other developments to create employment and additional facilities in our community.

The key role of the Development Officer is to underpin the work of the Board and GBCDT volunteers in taking control of the project themselves, they will therefore largely have a supporting, enabling and administrative role.

Principle areas of work include supporting the Board to inform, involve and engage the community, assisting the Board in completing the pontoon project and undertaking discrete pieces of market research work for additional income generation. They will also assist the Board with administrative tasks such as organising meetings and events, booking venues and taking minutes.

Applicants must have excellent communication skills, a good track record of completing funding applications and managing claims, a keen interest in the work of land trusts and a willingness to work outside normal office hours as required. The ability to work unsupervised is essential. Remote working may be considered. Employment will be for a 15-month period ending no later than the end of March 2023 in the first instance. An extension is dependent on on-going grant funding as a result of actions taken by the Board and post holder. This post is funded by The Scottish Government through Highlands and Islands Enterprise.

For further information and an application pack please contact Anne Ryan, Chair, Great Bernera Community Development Trust. trustbernera@hotmail.com or telephone **07786963481**

CLOSING DATE FOR APPLICATIONS IS 5pm on 27th December 2021

BCA ADMINISTRATOR ROLE - FULL TIME OR PART TIME, JOB SHARE AVAILABLE

Exciting Job opportunity.

We are still looking to recruit an administrator to maintain, manage and develop the community centre for activities promoted by the Bernera Community Association.

1 year, fixed term full time or part time, job share possible 37.5hrs/week

£19-23.4K (dependent on previous experience)

New closing date extended to 31/12/2021 @6pm. Download the job pack and apply www.bit.ly/JobBCA2021



CHOCOLATE COFFEE MERINGUE ROULADE

A rich roulade that combines meringue, chocolate and coffee is a guaranteed crowdpleaser at any dinner party.

Ingredients:

Sunflower oil for greasing
6 medium free-range egg whites
330g golden caster sugar
2 tbsp plain flour
60g ground almonds
1 tbsp espresso coffee powder dissolved in 1 tsp boiling water
Handful flaked almonds
Dark chocolate, melted, to drizzle

For the chocolate spread

200g dark chocolate (70% cocoa solids), chopped into chunks
50g salted butter
120ml double cream
½ tsp sea salt flakes

For the cream filling

200ml double cream
40g icing sugar
1 tsp espresso coffee powder, dissolved in 1 tsp boiling water

Method:

1. Heat the oven to 200°C/180°C fan/gas 6. Line a 23cm x 33cm lipped swiss roll tin or baking tray with baking paper, then lightly oil the paper.
2. In a large clean bowl, whisk the egg whites with an electric mixer until thick, glossy and holding medium peaks. On a low speed, whisk in the sugar, a little at a time, then add the flour, ground almonds and coffee until just combined.
3. Spread the meringue evenly into the tin, scatter over the flaked almonds, then bake for 8 minutes. Lower the oven temperature to 160°C/140°C fan/ gas 4 and cook for a further 20-25 minutes. Lift the meringue from the tin on its paper and cool for 10 minutes on a wire rack, then invert onto another piece of baking paper to cool completely.
4. Meanwhile, make the chocolate spread: melt the chocolate in a heatproof bowl over a pan of simmering water (don't let the water touch the bowl). When melted, add the butter and stir gently, then leave to cool for 15 minutes. Add the cream gradually, beating between additions with a balloon whisk, then add the salt. Spread evenly over the cooled meringue, then chill the whole dessert for 15 minutes.
5. For the cream filling, put the cream, icing sugar and coffee in a clean mixing bowl. Whisk with an electric mixer until it starts to thicken. Continue in bursts until you get soft peaks (that fall over).
6. Spread the cream on top of the chocolate spread. Starting with a short edge, carefully roll up the meringue, using the baking paper to help. Wrap the paper tightly around and chill for at least 3 hours.
To serve, put on a plate, drizzle with melted chocolate and slice.
The Bernera Bakes honesty box is open again and chock full of yummy goodies!



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



BERNERA CHRISTMAS FAIR



The Christmas Fair was well attended and it was so lovely to see so many from the community out in the hall, supporting the businesses and enjoying being together. The BCA was host to the Uig School Choir and it was remarked by a visitor that not only was Bernera getting a second bridge for Christmas, but that the Bernera had built a bridge to the community in Uig.

Santa's Grotto hosted 30 children and Santa was ably supported by one of his elves, in gifting small presents to those who attended. It was lovely to see so many of the island's young children surrounded by friends from Uig and beyond. One young visitor was so pleased to visit Santa, but was concerned as to where his Reindeer were being parked whilst he was busy in the Grotto. They reported back later via a parent, that they had seen them munching grass on the moor on their way home to Uig and were completely delighted to have seen the whole ensemble. Magic moments for the family involved.

The Elves Kitchen (aka the Cafe), was staffed by volunteers, bringing lovely soup and sandwiches with a festive twist to tables that were full all day long, and the customers enjoyed being able to spend time together.

Children's crafts and games kept the younger ones entertained and together with the stall holders' contributions and raffle raised just over £700 for the BCA's funds. Congratulations to everyone who attended and volunteered.



NOTICE OF FIRST REGISTRATION OF CROFTS

Notices on behalf of Derek Mackenzie, Solicitors, 20 North Beach Street, Stornoway, Isle of Lewis, HS1 2XQ

Donald John Smith, residing at 30B Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, has registered his croft 27 Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, on the Crofting Register held by the Register of Scotland. Any person who wishes to challenge the registration may apply to the Scottish Land Court by 30 August 2022.

Details of the registration can be found at www.crofts.ros.gov.uk/register/home. The croft registration number is **C8080**.

Donald John Smith, residing at 30B Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, has registered his croft 28 Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, on the Crofting Register held by the Register of Scotland. Any person who wishes to challenge the registration may apply to the Scottish Land Court by 30 August 2022.

Details of the registration can be found at www.crofts.ros.gov.uk/register/home. The croft registration number is **C8079**.

Donald John Smith, residing at 30B Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, has registered his croft 29 Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, on the Crofting Register held by the Register of Scotland. Any person who wishes to challenge the registration may apply to the Scottish Land Court by 30 August 2022.

Details of the registration can be found at www.crofts.ros.gov.uk/register/home. The croft registration number is **C8078**.

Donald John Smith, residing at 30B Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, has registered his croft 30A Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, on the Crofting Register held by the Register of Scotland. Any person who wishes to challenge the registration may apply to the Scottish Land Court by 30 August 2022.

Details of the registration can be found at www.crofts.ros.gov.uk/register/home. The croft registration number is **C8077**.

Donald John Smith, residing at 30B Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, has registered his croft 30B Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, on the Crofting Register held by the Register of Scotland. Any person who wishes to challenge the registration may apply to the Scottish Land Court by 30 August 2022.

Details of the registration can be found at www.crofts.ros.gov.uk/register/home. The croft registration number is **C8076**.

BERNERA COMMUNITY CAROL SERVICE

5.30pm

Sunday 19th December 2021

Bernera Church of Scotland

All Welcome



POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS - CHRISTMAS EVE IN BETHLEHEM



When I graduated in 1982 the jobs market was very difficult and so I applied to the Church of Scotland as a volunteer at the Tiberias Hospice in Israel. I was successful and arrived there in October of that year, staying for eight months.

Along with another volunteer, Annabel, I was lucky enough to be able to stay at the CofS Hospice in Jerusalem for Christmas and we managed to get tickets to travel to Bethlehem for Christmas eve. It was a time of tension in Israel with a lot of concerns with their neighbours Lebanon and Syria, indeed I well remember the tank transporters rumbling past in Tiberias on the way to the Lebanon border. That Christmas there were rumours of Arab Christians planning on disrupting the celebrations on Bethlehem.

Annabel and I arrived at the Jaffa gate about 9pm and joined the queues for the busses to Bethlehem. After passing through metal detectors and pat downs we boarded the crowded Egged bus, passed the armed Israeli soldier riding shotgun at the front, for the twenty minute trip to Bethlehem. Once there we joined another queue for metal detectors and searches surrounded by soldiers before we were able to pass through the city gate into Manger Square. The square was packed with people of all nationalities, and yes a great many Arabs, it was very difficult to move about, shuffle and push was the order of the day. Easily seen on all the roof tops round the square were more armed soldiers and tension filled the air.

The Church of the Nativity was not open to the public so we had expected there to be a light festive mood with a build up to midnight and some sort of worship in the crowded Manger Square. This did not happen and midnight came and went without much celebration. Somewhat disappointed we joined the queues for the bus back to Jerusalem and wondered why did we go.

However, on reflection I felt that I had experienced a more realistic Bethlehem Christmas than the rose tinted one I had expected. When Joseph and Mary went there for the roman census there would have been a lot of tension in the air with all the people being forced to go to Bethlehem and the roman soldiers not knowing what could happen. Very much like I experienced that Christmas eve of 1982 and something that I still remember every Christmas.

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



TV QUIZ

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Walmington-on-Sea defended by | 18. Pans People danced on |
| 2. Sun Hill was policed by | 19. In which city did Beechgrove Garden start |
| 3. Eye Level is the theme for | 20. The anti-corruption unit in Line of Duty is |
| 4. ITVs answer to Blue Peter | 21. Animal Magic was voiced by |
| 5. All Creatures Great and Small based on books by | 22. Starbug is the shuttle for which spaceship |
| 6. Naga Munchetty is a presenter on | 23. Thunderbirds Are Go are based on |
| 7. ITV station covering region in Scotland and England | 24. Oliver Queen is the |
| 8. Who has a black and white cat | 25. Home of legendary creatures |
| 9. The 1960's Batman actor was | 26. Emmerdale was originally based on a |
| 10. Antiques Roadtrip series in May 2021 was the | 27. 1965 to 1985 4pm Saturday on World of Sport for |
| 11. Johnny Weissmuller was | 28. Jack and Victor are Still Game in |
| 12. The best score on this show is | 29. The KGB Man from UNCLE was |
| 13. One frame snooker competition | 30. Para Handy was the captain of |
| 14. Inspector Blakey was | |
| 15. A Very English Scandal was about whose downfall | |
| 16. Where things are put right again | |
| 17. Scottish football program on BBC | |

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost

